How much of your repo is already

dead?

Functions nobody calls. Imports nobody uses.
Code that can never run. Variables nobody reads.

You know it's in there.
You're just too scared to delete any of it.

The evidence

Engineers spend 13.5 hours a week on technical debt.

Stripe Developer Coefficient, Harris Poll of 1,000+ devs

Technical debt is the #1 workplace frustration (62%).

Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

AI coding tools make it worse: generated snippets breed copy-paste bloat nobody fully understands.

The cost

Roughly a third of engineering capacity,
burned on debt instead of features.

For a 10-person team at $180K per engineer:
about $594,000 a year, haunted.

Ghost in the Repo

The dead-code hunter that turns cleanup
into a Halloween ghost hunt.

HAUNT: scan any Python repo, get a ghost report
HAUNTING ISSUES: every ghost becomes a GitHub issue
EXORCISE: one-click safe removal, diff preview, undo

Before / after: real numbers

Ran on the author's own video-pipeline scripts:

8 ghosts found: 1 wraith, 1 specter, 6 shades

9 dead lines exorcised, rescan came back clean

Every removal previewed as a diff first.

Zero false positives. Zero broken files.

Team

Built solo by Velu Murugan
with an AI build partner, in Hackyard Yard #5.

Next: more languages, and a CI ghost
that haunts every pull request.